Introduction to the course

CSE 101 Section 03
Introduction to Algorithms and Computing
Fall 2023
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Instructor

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Meeting times

Day	Time	What	Where
Tuesday	12:40 - 13:30	Lecture	Sawyer 3412
Tuesday	14:40 - 16:30	Lab	Currie 100
Thursday	12:40 - 13:30	Lecture	Sawyer 4408

CSE101: Introduction to Algorithms and Computing

- Objective: the design and implementation of computational solutions to simple problems in a high-level language (Python).

- Things that you can expect to learn about in this course:
  - Computational thinking
  - Basic computational tools such as selection and iteration
  - Algorithms for tasks, such as searching and sorting.
  - Low-level concepts, such as the representation of data in computers and the Von Neumann machine,

In simple terms

We are going to:

- Learn about algorithms, i.e. the precise set of steps to solve a given problems.

- Learn how to communicate the set of steps to a computer using a (programming) language it can understand (in this course Python).

Course Material

- All course material will be made available on the instructor's website https://mariam-elmezouar.github.io/ under the tab CSE101.

- Direct link to course: https://mariam-elmezouar.github.io/CSE101/index.html
- Link posted on Moodle.

Course Material

- The tab General contains all the information presented today (use it as your syllabus and refer to it whenever in doubt).
- The tab Schedule will be your main go-to to track due dates, exam dates, and to download lecture notes, exercises, and resources.
- The tab Laboratories will contain the lab-specific instructions, resources, and due dates.

Course Assessments

Your performance in this course will be assessed as follows:

Assessment type	Weight	Quantity
Midterm exam	20%	1
Laboratories	25%	9
Quizzes	5%	10
Final Exam	50%	1

Course Assessments: Labs

- Labs solutions are to be submitted on Moodle.
- All labs are to be performed individually, unless otherwise indicated.
- Lab reports are due by 11:59pm on the day before the next lab is set to happen (i.e. Mondays by 11:59pm). Exact due dates will be indicated on the website and on the submission link on Moodle.
- Late submissions will be penalized 25% for each 24 hours late after the deadline. There will be no penalty if submitted within the first 6 hours after the deadline (think of it as a grace period).
- You cannot take the final exam unless you have submitted all your lab reports.

Course Assessments: Quizzes

- Quizzes will take place on Moodle (i.e., on computer).
- Quizzes will happen in the first 5-15 minutes of the lab sessions on Tuesdays. The specific dates will be shown on the schedule in the course website.
- Quizzes will be a set of multiple-choice questions, that will test your understanding of any of the material covered in the week before.
- Quizzes are individual.

Course Assessments: Midterm

- The tentative date of the midterm is October 17th (to be confirmed at the beginning of October).

- The midterm exam will be on paper, with a duration of 110 minutes.

- There will be a midterm review right before the midterm exam.

Course Assessments: Final Exam

- The date of the final exam will be announced towards the end of the term.

- It will test your understanding of all material covered during the term, including the lecture notes, exercises, labs, etc.

- You cannot pass the course unless you pass the final exam. If you fail the final exam, your final grade of the course will be that of the final exam.

Expectations

- Arrive on time and come prepared.

- Make sure you understand all the course-related materiel. If in doubt, ask.

- This is a course where you <u>learn by doing</u>. If you take shortcuts (i.e., try to find solutions online), you will <u>struggle</u> when you do not have access to online resources (i.e., midterm and final exams – 70% of your grade). Practice is the key.

Academic Misconduct

1. RMC's academic integrity regulations can be found here: https://www.rmc-cmr.ca/en/registrars-office/academic-regulations#ai

2. Please read the document "*Clarifications on Academic Misconduct and Plagiarism in Computer Science*" (found on the course website), sign your name and submit it on Moodle.

Communication with your instructor

- Emails will be used to communicate any relevant information to the students.
- The best way to reach me is by email. Include the course name CSE101 in your email subject (e.g. CSE101: Question about lab 1).
- Office hours can be scheduled by email.

Next…

Introduction to programming